

Chapter 4 – Metasploit Framework

Part 8 – Workspaces, Loot & Reporting

Overview

Workspaces help organize penetration testing projects by separating hosts, services, vulnerabilities, notes, credentials, and collected artifacts into independent assessment databases.

Workspace Management

workspace - List workspaces.
workspace -a NAME - Create a workspace.
workspace NAME - Switch workspace.
workspace -d NAME - Delete a workspace.

Database Objects

hosts - View discovered hosts.
services - View discovered services.
vulns - Review recorded vulnerabilities.
notes - Display notes.
notes -a - Add notes.
creds - View stored credentials.
loot - View collected assessment artifacts.

Database Commands

db_status - Check database connectivity.
db_import FILE - Import supported scan results into the active workspace.

Reporting Workflow

Create workspace → Verify database → Import scan results → Review hosts and services → Record notes → Validate findings → Collect evidence → Prepare the final report.

Best Practices

Use a separate workspace for every engagement, keep notes throughout testing, verify database status before starting, organize evidence carefully, and write findings as they are validated.

Quick Revision

Workspaces separate projects, the database stores assessment information, and good documentation is just as important as technical testing.